THE SANGAM AGE

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Name / Book 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Sangam	Gatherings of Tamil poets and bards held in the city of Madurai between 1st century BCE and 2nd century CE.
Sage Agastya	Legendary sage believed to have attended the first Sangam.
Tolkappiyam	The oldest book of Tamil grammar; the only surviving work from the second Sangam.
Tolkappiar	The author of the *Tolkappiyam*.
Three Kingdoms	Cheras, Pandyas, and Cholas; their wars form the themes of Sangam literature.
Cheras	The kingdom that finally asserted its supremacy over the other two kingdoms.
Patinenkilkanakku	The "eighteen minor works" of Sangam literature, of which *Tirukkural* is a celebrated part.
Thiruvalluvar	Tamil poet and philosopher who wrote the *Tirukkural*.
Aram	First section of *Tirukkural* dealing with righteousness (ethical living in private life).

Term / Name / Book 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Porul	Second section of *Tirukkural* dealing with wealth and public affairs.
Inbam or Kamam	Third section of *Tirukkural* dealing with pleasure (ethical living in private life).
The Five Epics	Jivakachintamani, Manimekalai, Silappadikaram, Valayapathi, and Kuntalakeshi.
Megaliths	Box-like structures erected with stone slabs without mortar; acted as burial sites or memorials.
Grave Goods	Items like pottery and iron objects found in megaliths providing insight into Sangam Age life.
Champakalakshmi	Renowned historian who identified the Sangam Age with the last phase of the megalithic culture.

📍 THE SANGAM AGE 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Sangam Age refers to period when bulk of Tamil literature was composed by Tamil scholars and poets ➔ took place in three successive literary gatherings called Sangam.
    - Sangam refers to gatherings of poets and bards between first century BCE and second century CE ➔ held in the city of Madurai.
    - First Sangam attended by Gods and legendary sages including Sage Agastya ➔ all its works have perished.

- Second Sangam produced a large mass of literature ➔ only Tolkappiyam by Tolkappiar (oldest book of Tamil grammar) has survived.
- Third Sangam produced vast literature ➔ only a fraction survived constituting the extant body of Sangam literature.
- Three kingdoms of Cheras, Pandyas and Cholas were always at war ➔ wars and heroic deeds form themes of Sangam literature ➔ Cheras finally asserted supremacy over the other two kingdoms. ⚔️🛡️

📍 **SOURCES: 1. Tirukkural** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Tirukkural is one of most celebrated works of the eighteen minor works (Patinenkilkanakku) ➔ written by Thiruvalluvar (Tamil poet and philosopher).
  - Considered a compound of the teachings of Dharamashastra, Arthashastra and Kamasutra ➔ comprises metrical proverbs on life and religion.
  - Organised into 133 chapters ➔ preaches simplicity and truth.
  - Grouped into three sections: (a) Aram (righteousness); (b) Porul (wealth); (c) Inbam or Kamam (pleasure).
  - Aram and Inbam discuss ethical living in private life ➔ Porul deals with public affairs.
  - Tamil literature comprises five epics: Jivakachintamani, Manimekalai, Silappadikaram, Valayapathi, Kuntalakeshi ➔ provide vast treasure of information about music, dance, administration and grandeur (luxuries) of Kings. 📜✨

📍 **SOURCES: 2. Megaliths** 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- Megaliths are box-like structures (big rocks) ➔ erected with stone slabs resting on each other without any mortar ➔ acted as burial sites or commemorative memorials (for Raja).
- Stone circles or boulders placed on surface served as signposts to locate a burial site ➔ allowed people to return to the same place.
- Some megaliths contain more than one skeleton ➔ indicates people of same family were buried in same place at different time periods ➔ also known as memorial stones.
- Contained skeletons and grave goods including pottery and iron objects ➔ provide useful insight about life during Sangam Age.
- Fewer agricultural tools compared to fishing and hunting tools ➔ concluded that advanced agriculture was not practised.
- Religious beliefs can be inferred from grave goods ➔ presence of tridents in graves shows faith in Lord Shiva.
- Historian Champakalakshmi identified Sangam Age with last phase of megalithic culture in Tamil region ➔ substantiated viewpoint by correlating *velir* settlements from literature with megalithic sites of the far south.
- This correlation includes (a) subsistence base consisting of agriculture, cattle rearing and fishing; (b) the use of iron; (c) a period in which warfare and weapons were important. 🪨🔱

🧠 **High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver)** 📌

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Kaundi Adigal & Manimekalai	Female ascetics belonging to the Buddhist or Jain tradition.
Kannagi or Pattini	'The Chaste Lady'; her worship was an extension of the Goddess of Chastity.

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Senaguttuvan	Chera ruler who made the worship of Kannagi popular.
Sri Lanka & Malwa	Distant places in the South and North respectively where Kannagi worship spread.
Rice	The main crop and staple of the Sangam Age agriculture.
Chera Country	Region noted for its jackfruit, pepper, and turmeric.
Chola Country	Region noted for its high paddy yields.
Uraiyur	A major centre of the cotton trade.
Angadi	Established markets located in the bigger towns.
Paddy	The most commonly accepted medium of exchange (barter), especially in rural areas.
Puhar	Port city where big ships entered bringing precious merchandise from overseas.
Saliyur	One of the most important ports, located in the **Pandya** country.
Bandar	One of the most important ports, located in the **Chera** country.

Term / Name / Place 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
The Periplus of the Red Sea	A book describing the navigation and trade of the Roman Empire and India.
Naura (Cannanore)	A port of leading importance on the west coast mentioned in the *Periplus*.
Tyndis (Ponnani)	A port of leading importance on the west coast mentioned in the *Periplus*.
Muziris (Cranganore)	A port of leading importance on the west coast mentioned in the *Periplus*.
Andhra Region	Region noted in the *Periplus* where a great quantity of muslin was made.
Roman Coins	Gold and silver coins found in the interior of Tamil land, indicating the vast extent of trade.

📍 POSITION OF WOMEN 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Status of women in Sangam society was not equal to that of men ➔ society consisted of different kinds of women ➔ (1) married women settled down as dutiful housewives looking after husbands and children ➔ (2) female ascetics belonging to Buddhist or Jain tradition like Kaundi Adigal and Manimekalai ➔ (3) large number of courtesans/dancers ➔ however, women enjoyed freedom of movement in society ➔ number of women poets of the age is proof that women were provided with good education ➔ worship of Kannagi or Pattini ('the Chaste Lady') was perhaps a very early institution ➔ was an extension of the worship of the Goddess of

Chastity ➔ seems to have become popular with the Chera ruler Senaguttuvan's worship of Kannagi ➔ spread to distant places like Sri Lanka in the South and Malwa in the North. 🛕👩

📍 ECONOMY 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Economy during Sangam Age was simple and self-sufficient ➔ people were industrious and believed in living well by earning wealth ➔ literature points to existence of both the wealthy and the poor in society ➔ wealthy people included kings and those who surrounded them ➔ poor were either farm and casual labourers or wandering minstrels ➔ division of social groups into rich and poor was accepted as natural ➔ poverty was considered the result of past actions of men. ⚖️🪙

📍 AGRICULTURE 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Agriculture was the main occupation ➔ main crop was rice ➔ other crops included cotton, ragi, sugarcane, pepper, ginger, cardamom, turmeric, cinnamon, different varieties of fruits ➔ construction of embankments and canals for irrigation was undertaken by the state ➔ Chera country was noted for its jackfruit, pepper and turmeric ➔ in Chola country paddy yields were high ➔ many rural activities described in detail in Sangam poems ➔ including cultivation of ragi and sugarcane, making of sugar from cane, harvesting and drying of grain. 🌾🌴

📍 OTHER OCCUPATIONS 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Next to agriculture, spinning and weaving were most widely practised crafts ➔ spinning and weaving of cotton (and perhaps silk) attained high degree of perfection ➔ spinning was part-time occupation of women ➔ weaving of complex patterns on cloth and silk often mentioned in literature ➔ Uraiyur was a major centre of cotton trade ➔ poems mention cotton cloth as thin as snake skin or

cloud of steam ➔ so finely woven that eye could not follow course of thread ➔ scissors and needles were known ➔ in addition to cotton and silk, cloth made of wood fibre was also used by priestly class ➔ dyeing was a widespread ancillary industry to weaving ➔ ship-building, metalworking, carpentry, rope-making, ornament-making, tanning, and making of ivory products were widely practised. 📝✂️

📍 TRADE 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Literature is full of details regarding commercial activities of people ➔ trade (internal and foreign) well organised and briskly carried on throughout period ➔ caravans of merchants with carts and pack-animals carried merchandise from place to place ➔ most trade carried on by barter ➔ paddy constituted most commonly accepted medium of exchange (specially in rural areas) ➔ salt sold for paddy ➔ paddy sold by mentioning its price in terms of salt ➔ honey and roots exchanged for fish oil ➔ established markets called 'angadi' in bigger towns ➔ elsewhere hawkers carried goods to houses of people ➔ extensive trade with foreign countries ➔ Tamil land had commodities in great demand in foreign markets ➔ included pepper, ginger, cardamom, cinnamon, turmeric, ivory products, pearls, precious stones ➔ main imports included horses, gold and glass ➔ port cities were centres of foreign trade ➔ big ships entered port of Puhar bringing precious merchandise from overseas ➔ family of rich merchants lived on upper floors while lower ones set apart for business ➔ Saliyur in Pandya country and Bandar in Chera are counted among most important ports ➔ book 'The Periplus of the Red Sea' describes navigation and trade of Roman empire ➔ gives information on trade between India and Roman empire ➔ mentions ports of Naura (Cannanore), Tyndis (identified with Ponnani) and Muziris (Cranganore) as of leading importance on west coast ➔ Periplus mentions Uraiyur ➔ pearls from coast sent to Uraiyur and exported ➔ notes great quantity of muslin made in region of Andhra ➔ gold and silver coins from

Roman empire found in interior of Tamil land indicate extent of the trade. 🚢 💎